



“We are a manifestation of our ancestors’ prayers.”

Keeya Wiki, a 17-year-old member of the Yurok Tribe



PHOTOS BY MELINA MARA/THE WASHINGTON POST

Indigenous teens make first descent of a sacred river finally flowing free

BY REIS THEBAULT, ALICE LI AND MELINA MARA

ALONG THE KLAMATH RIVER

The journey was no longer impossible, but that didn’t make it any less audacious. One great waterway, newly freed from the stranglehold of four hulking dams. More than 300 miles, through some of the most intense rapids in the West. And 15 young kayakers, nearly all of them new to the sport.

Their goal: the first full descent of the Klamath River, from its headwaters near the Cascade Mountains in Oregon to its mouth on the Pacific coast of California.

If they could pull it off, it would be monumental, marking the success of the largest dam removal project in American history.

Yet for the teens, all descendants of the region’s Indigenous tribes, it would also be profoundly symbolic. Parents and grandparents had fought for decades to undam the Klamath, a sacred lifeblood. Now this generation would be the first to travel the river’s entirety.

The challenge was daunting — and exhilarating. They would spend 30 days on the river, with The Washington Post following the odyssey.

SEE KLAMATH ON A12



TOP: A flotilla of supporters gathered near the mouth of the Klamath on July 11 to celebrate the first full descent of the river after the removal of four dams. ABOVE: Coley Miller was one teen who made the journey. Her family spent years protesting the dams. “I feel like I’m representing that fight,” she said.

IRS chief’s ouster came after dispute over migrant data

DHS SOUGHT CONFIDENTIAL TAXPAYER INFO

Request was deemed outside confines of sharing deal

BY JACOB BOGAGE AND KADIA GOBA

The Internal Revenue Service clashed with the White House over using tax data to help locate suspected undocumented immigrants hours before Trump administration officials forced IRS Commissioner Billy Long from his post Friday, according to two people familiar with the situation.

The Department of Homeland Security sent the IRS a list Thursday of 40,000 names of people DHS officials thought were in the country illegally and asked the IRS to use confidential taxpayer data to verify their addresses, said the people, who spoke on the condition of anonymity for fear of reprisals.

The Treasury Department, the parent agency of the IRS, and DHS agreed to an arrangement in April to facilitate such data sharing — over the objections of the tax ser-

vice’s privacy lawyers.

DHS officials have suggested they would eventually ask the IRS for help locating 7 million people. There are about 11 million undocumented immigrants in the United States, according to federal estimates.

On Friday, though, the IRS responded that it was able to verify fewer than 3 percent of the names immigration enforcement officials submitted, the people said.

The names the agency could match were mainly the individuals for whom DHS provided an individual taxpayer identification number. An ITIN is an IRS-specific ID that immigrants often use in place of a Social Security number on a tax filing. Undocumented immigrants pay tens of billions of dollars in taxes each year, which

SEE WHITE HOUSE ON A16

Higher education: Trump seeks to force handover of data on race. **A11**

U.S. wields tariffs for national security goals

Documents show plan to press nations near China for closer defense ties

BY DAVID J. LYNCH AND HANNAH NATANSON

President Donald Trump’s free-wheeling use of tariffs as a tool of American power may have been more extensive than was publicly known, encompassing an array of national security goals as well as the interests of individual companies, according to internal government documents obtained by The Washington Post.

This month, State Department officials considered demanding that U.S. trading partners vote against an international effort to reduce greenhouse gas emissions

by the oceangoing container ships that are the backbone of global trade. In a draft “action memo,” Secretary of State Marco Rubio was told that department officials had sought “to inject this issue into the ongoing bilateral trade negotiations” with maritime nations such as Singapore.

That move came after administration officials this past spring debated broadening trade negotiations with more than a dozen nations, including by requiring Israel to eliminate a Chinese company’s control of a key port and insisting that South Korea publicly support deploying U.S. troops to deter China as well as Seoul’s traditional rival, North Korea, the documents said.

Administration officials saw trade talks as an opportunity to achieve objectives that went far beyond Trump’s oft-stated goal of

SEE TRADE ON A17

Zelensky rebuffs Trump on ceding territory to Moscow

Ukrainian leader not invited to Friday summit with Putin in Alaska

BY SIOBHÁN O’GRADY AND CATHERINE BELTON

KYIV — Ukraine will reject any proposal that involves ceding territory to Russia, Ukrainian President Volodymyr Zelensky said Saturday, hours after President Donald Trump suggested “some swapping of territories” to end Russia’s war on Ukraine.

“The answer to the Ukrainian territorial question is already in the constitution of Ukraine,” Zelensky said in a video address Saturday morning. “No one will retreat from this, and no one can. Ukrainians will not give their land to the occupier.”

Trump had suggested a territorial swap as he and Russian President Vladimir Putin finalized details for an in-person meeting

Friday in Alaska — symbolic as a former part of the Russian Empire.

Trump did not say whether Zelensky was invited to the meeting. An official briefed on the negotiations, who spoke on the condition of anonymity to speak freely about sensitive political talks, said Zelensky had not yet been invited.

Russia has proposed that Kyiv relinquish the Donbas area of eastern Ukraine for a ceasefire without offering anything in return, according to a second person briefed on the negotiations.

European and Ukrainian officials were scrambling to respond to Trump’s reversal. Days before he and Putin announced the meeting Friday, he was threatening to impose tougher sanctions on Russia.

Britain on Saturday hosted a meeting of national security advisers from Europe, Ukraine and the United States led by Foreign Secretary David Lammy and Vice President JD Vance.

SEE ZELENSKY ON A18

Democrats play risky hand in redistricting battle

After months of discussions, the party adopts a combative posture against the GOP over election maps

BY YVONNE WINGETT SANCHEZ, PATRICK MARLEY AND MARIANNA SOTOMAYOR

As word spread around the Texas Capitol in the spring that Republicans were planning to redraw the congressional map to boost their chances in the mid-terms, Democratic state lawmakers started sketching out a plan to resist.

By summertime, over dozens of Zoom meetings fueled by coffee, energy drinks and bland sandwiches, state House Minority Leader Gene Wu (D), a low-key Houston attorney, strategized with his colleagues. They would end up speaking with blue state governors such as Gavin Newsom of California; congressional Democrats such as House Minority Leader Hakeem Jeffries of New York; and former attorney general Eric Holder, among others.

By Aug. 1, two days after Texas Republicans unveiled their map, Wu and his lieutenants instruct-



RICH PEDRONCELLI/AP

Accompanied by California and Texas lawmakers on Friday, California Gov. Gavin Newsom discusses the push to schedule a special election to redraw his state’s congressional districts.

Iowa: Democratic Sen. Ruben Gallego’s visit generates buzz for 2028. **A5**

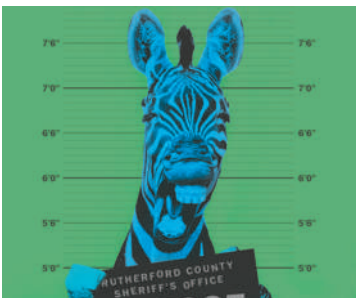
Texas: FBI can’t do much to return Democratic legislators, experts say. **A7**

THE NATION

Sandra Grimes, 79, who exposed a deadly CIA traitor, has died. **A9**

SPORTS

Golf nuts endure a 44-hour wait in a Long Island lot to play a legend. **B1**



BUSINESS

Humans can learn from some of the greatest zoo escapes in history. **B9**

METRO

Thousands of anime fans turn the nation’s capital into a costume party. **B17**



ARTS & STYLE

Sharon Stone still won’t fall in line for Hollywood. And not just on film.

TRAVEL

This Alabama space camp lets adults live out their astronaut dreams.

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